

The Open Question Rule

Use *why, what, how*. Never: *do, would, could, should*.

Closed or leading (avoid)

Would you use this?

Do you think this is a problem?

Could you see yourself paying?

Should we include feature X?

Is this interesting?

Is budget tight?

Does this matter to you?

Open behavioural (use)

When did you last solve this, and how?

Walk me through the last time this came up for you.

What did you spend on similar tools in the last 12 months?

Show me how you handle this today.

What are you spending most of your time on this quarter?

Who signed off your last software purchase? Walk me through that.

When did you last try to solve this? What happened?

THE FIVE SIGNALS YOU ARE LISTENING FOR

Recency and frequency

When did this last happen? How often?

Concrete behaviour

What exactly did they do, not plan to do?

Time and money spent

How much have they invested in solving it already?

Problem-area match

Is the pain in the domain you are targeting?

Awareness level

Do they know they have this problem, or call it something else?